Khān-qulī put forth his opinion and said, ‘This will never do! They will take us all. From amongst the horses, there are, you take two good ones and go quickly on with Mīrzā Qulī Kūkūldāsh, each with a led horse. Maybe you will get away.’*

Babur said, ‘He did not speak ill; as there was no fighting to hand, there was a chance of safety in doing as he said, but it really would not have looked well to leave any man alone, without a horse, amongst his foes.’

In the end, they all dropped off, one by one. Babur’s horse was a little tired too. Seeing this, Khān-qulī offered his horse to Babur and took his in return. The foe unhorsed Sayyidī Qarā’s ‘Abdu’l-qadūs and Nāṣir’s Shāham, who had fallen behind. Khān-qulī also was left away. Babur was running out of time, and he was in no position to offer any help or defence. Their horses had begun to flag. Babur’s horse had started to get tired while Dost Beg’s failed and stopped. At that moment, Qaṃbar-‘alī got off and exchanged his horse with Babur. Soon he got left behind too. Now, Babur was left only with Mīrzā Qulī Kūkūldāsh. Their horses no longer galloped but only trotted. When Mīrzā Qulī Kūkūldāsh’s horse began to flag, Babur said, ‘What will become of me, if you fall behind? Come along! let’s live or die together.’ Babur hopefully looked at him multiple times. After long he said, ‘My horse is done! It can’t go on. Never mind me! You go on, perhaps you will get away.’

About this situation, Babur has said, ‘It was a miserable position for me; he remained behind, I was alone.’

They could sight two men, Bābā of Sairām and Banda-‘alī, of the enemies’ camp. Babur’s borrowed horse was also almost done, and the mountains were still a couple of miles off. His path was full of a pile of rocks. Babur thought, ‘My horse is worn out and the hills are still somewhat far away; which way should I go? In my quiver are at least twenty arrows; should I dismount and shoot them off from this pile of rock?’ Then a second thought came to Babur’s mind. He thought that he might reach the hills and once there, stick a few arrows in his belt and scramble up. Babur had somehow gained a lot of confidence. His feet seemed to be charged, and so, he went on. His horse was failing to gallop but the two men were within arrow’s reach now. But Babur chose not to shoot for the lack of arrows. At the same time, those two men didn’t come nearer either. As the dusk came, Babur had almost reached the hills. Suddenly, he could hear the voice of the two men. They said, ‘Where are you going in this way? Jahāngīr Mīrzā has